

DRAFT - FOR REVIEW ONLY**COMMENCEMENT SPEAKER ENGAGEMENT AGREEMENT**

This Commencement Speaker Engagement Agreement (the "**Agreement**") is made as of **May 8, 2026** (the "**Effective Date**") by and between **The Trustees of Columbia University in the City of New York**, acting through the **Office of University Commencement**, 116th Street and Broadway, New York, New York 10027 ("**University**"), and **Sammy Abdella**, address on file with University ("**Speaker**"). University and Speaker may be referred to individually as a "**Party**" and collectively as the "**Parties**."

RECITALS

WHEREAS, University will hold its 2026 undergraduate University Commencement celebration on **Wednesday, May 20, 2026, from 5:00 p.m. to 6:30 p.m.** on the Morningside Campus in New York, New York (the "**Event**");

WHEREAS, University desires to invite Speaker to deliver commencement remarks in connection with the Event; and

WHEREAS, Speaker desires to participate in the Event under the terms set forth below.

NOW, THEREFORE, in consideration of the mutual covenants contained herein, the Parties agree as follows:

1. Engagement and Role

University engages Speaker, and Speaker accepts the engagement, to appear as a commencement speaker and deliver remarks at the Event. Speaker's role is ceremonial and limited to participation in the Event and directly related protocol activities approved by University.

2. Event Details

The Event shall be identified as the Columbia University 2026 undergraduate University Commencement celebration. The Event is scheduled for Wednesday, May 20, 2026, from 5:00 p.m. to 6:30 p.m. Eastern Time on Columbia University's Morningside Campus, New York, New York 10027. The expected length of Speaker's remarks is approximately eight to ten minutes, subject to reasonable adjustment by University for ceremony timing and accessibility needs.

3. Speaker Responsibilities

Speaker shall arrive at the location designated by University at the time specified by University; participate in reasonable Event protocol, including arrival briefing, robing if applicable, procession, seating, introduction, photographs, and related ceremonial activities; deliver original remarks suitable for a university commencement audience; cooperate with University staff regarding schedule, security, accessibility, media, and ceremony logistics; and provide a short biography, headshot, name pronunciation guidance, and any other reasonably requested Event materials by the deadlines provided by University.

4. University Responsibilities

University shall designate an Event representative to coordinate with Speaker; provide reasonable information regarding Event logistics, arrival time, venue access, security procedures, ceremony schedule, attire expectations, and protocol; provide academic regalia or attire instructions if applicable; provide reasonable on-site assistance on the Event date; and identify any applicable deadlines for Speaker materials.

5. Speech Content and Review

Speaker shall have primary responsibility for the content of Speaker's remarks. University may request an advance copy, outline, or summary of the remarks for purposes of timing, accessibility, captioning, translation, legal

compliance, institutional protocol, and ceremony coordination. University may provide reasonable guidance concerning length, audience, tone, safety, legal compliance, accessibility, and ceremonial appropriateness, and Speaker shall consider such guidance in good faith.

6. Travel, Lodging, and Approved Expenses

University may reimburse Speaker for reasonable Event-related travel, lodging, local transportation, and meal expenses only if such expenses are approved in writing in advance by an authorized University representative and documented in accordance with University policies. University shall not be responsible for expenses that are not pre-approved, are unsupported by required documentation, or exceed approved limits.

7. Recording, Photography, Livestream, and Publicity

Speaker acknowledges that the Event may be photographed, recorded, livestreamed, broadcast, captioned, translated, archived, and shared by University. Speaker grants University a non-exclusive, worldwide, royalty-free license to use Speaker's name, image, likeness, biography, voice, and Event remarks in connection with Event promotion, University websites and social media, livestreaming and archived recordings, news and alumni communications, institutional communications, accessibility, and non-commercial educational and historical purposes. University shall not use Speaker's name, image, likeness, or remarks in a manner that falsely implies Speaker's endorsement of an unrelated commercial product, service, political campaign, or institutional position.

8. Intellectual Property

Speaker retains ownership of any pre-existing intellectual property and original remarks authored by Speaker. University may reproduce, excerpt, display, distribute, livestream, archive, and otherwise use the remarks as reasonably necessary for Event-related, educational, archival, accessibility, news, and institutional purposes.

9. Public Announcements

University may publicly announce Speaker's participation in the Event after this Agreement is signed by both Parties, unless the Parties agree otherwise in writing. Speaker shall not issue any public announcement suggesting University endorsement, approval, or sponsorship beyond the Event engagement without University's prior written approval.

10. Campus Policies, Safety, and Security

Speaker shall comply with all applicable University policies, venue rules, security procedures, and lawful instructions from University personnel or public safety officials while participating in Event-related activities. University reserves the right to implement reasonable security, access, schedule, and safety requirements for the Event.

11. Confidentiality

Speaker shall keep confidential any non-public Event logistics, security arrangements, internal communications, private attendee information, or other confidential information disclosed by University, unless disclosure is authorized in writing by University or required by law.

12. Cancellation or Rescheduling by University

University may cancel, relocate, modify, or reschedule the Event or Speaker's appearance due to circumstances including, without limitation, severe weather, emergency conditions, public health concerns, security risks, labor disruptions, governmental restrictions, campus closure, or other circumstances beyond University's reasonable control. University shall provide notice as soon as reasonably practicable.

13. Cancellation by Speaker

Speaker shall promptly notify University if Speaker becomes unable to participate. If Speaker cancels, Speaker shall use reasonable efforts to assist University with transition planning, including providing written remarks, a recorded message, or other reasonable cooperation, if mutually agreed in writing.

14. Force Majeure

Neither Party shall be liable for failure or delay in performance caused by events beyond its reasonable control, including acts of God, natural disasters, war, terrorism, civil unrest, governmental action, public health emergency, labor disruption, transportation failure, or campus emergency. The affected Party shall provide notice as soon as reasonably practicable.

15. Independent Contractor

Speaker is engaged as an independent contractor and not as an employee, agent, partner, joint venturer, or representative of University. Speaker has no authority to bind University or make commitments on University's behalf.

16. Compliance with Law

Each Party shall comply with all applicable federal, state, and local laws, rules, and regulations in connection with this Agreement.

17. No Assignment

Speaker may not assign this Agreement or delegate Speaker's speaking obligations without University's prior written consent.

18. Governing Law

This Agreement shall be governed by and construed in accordance with the laws of the State of New York, without regard to conflict-of-law principles.

19. Entire Agreement; Amendment

This Agreement constitutes the entire understanding between the Parties regarding Speaker's engagement for the Event and supersedes all prior discussions, proposals, or understandings concerning its subject matter. Any amendment must be in writing and signed by both Parties.

20. Authority; Counterparts; Electronic Signatures

Each person signing this Agreement represents that the person is authorized to sign on behalf of the Party indicated below. This Agreement may be executed in counterparts, including by electronic signature, each of which shall be deemed an original and all of which together shall constitute one instrument.

IN WITNESS WHEREOF, the Parties have executed this Agreement as of the Effective Date.

**THE TRUSTEES OF COLUMBIA UNIVERSITY
IN THE CITY OF NEW YORK**

SPEAKER

By: _____

By: _____

Name: Authorized University Representative

Name: Sammy Abdella

Title: Authorized Signatory, Office of University Commencement

Title: Commencement Speaker

Date: May 8, 2026

Date: May 8, 2026